

Over a billion people are known to be active users of Microsoft Office worldwide. While it started off with just Microsoft Word, Microsoft Excel and Microsoft PowerPoint, today it contains a host of other applications, including Microsoft Outlook, Microsoft OneNote, Microsoft OneDrive, Skype for Business, Microsoft Teams, Microsoft Access, Microsoft Publisher, Microsoft Visio, Microsoft Project and other mobile apps as well as server applications. Microsoft applications can, today, be used for purposes ranging from writing a simple text document to scanning QR codes and from sharing files to social networking. The Office suite has given rise to its own characteristic file formats which are now treated as standard for their particular types of file and have gained compatibility with all other software in the industry.

Microsoft Office took root in 1990 when it was merely a bundle of three applications. The first mail application was Mail 3.0 and was released with Office 3.0 in 1992. It was here that the hegemony of Microsoft Office in professional mail systems started. Office 95 was the breakthrough version of Office and made it a household name just as computers were beginning to become household devices. Office 95 was fully 32 bit in nature, conforming with the configuration of Windows 95. Publisher, Project, Schedule+ and Bookshelf were also included in this version of Microsoft Office. This was also the first time Microsoft Office was divided into Office Standard and Office Professional Versions, with the Standard version containing just Word, Excel, PowerPoint and Scheduler. With Microsoft Office 97, Office software began to take the form in which Office is seen today. It included a major overhaul of the design of all the software included in the suite, making them more uniform in looks as well as commands. The command bar was introduced in this version of Office. This was also the first version to include spell checks and grammar checks. Microsoft Office 2000 was among the first softwares to add digital signatures, which gave an added layer of security to your documents. Office 2007 was the biggest major design overhaul for Microsoft Office since Office 97. It saw toolbars replaced by a ribbon and an all-new modern design interface known as the Fluent User Interface. Office 2007 also introduced a new file format based on XML, known as Open Office XML. Microsoft Office 2010, 2013 and 2016 saw several changes as well, including the introduction of Microsoft Office to mobile platforms on nearly every operating system. It added new tools for collaboration in which multiple users could work on the same file concurrently, a navigation panel as well as a ribbon that could be customised by the user.